Applicable across Mustard Group Limited and its subsidiaries

Policy owner	Human Resource Department
Approval authority	Board of Directors
Effective date	May, 2021
Review date	June 2026

1. **Introduction**

   Performance appraisal is the structured process through which the achievement of agreed objectives is reviewed, positive behaviour and organisational values are recognised, and actions are identified to support employee development. The employee whose performance is assessed is the "appraisee"; the person conducting the assessment is the "appraiser".

   Performance expectations and objectives must be communicated to employees, and the organisation should provide the necessary resources to support their achievement. Performance appraisal forms part of talent management and succession planning and helps the organisation understand employees' abilities, potential and career aspirations.

2. **Policy Statement**

   Mustard Group Limited is committed to a fair, consistent, transparent and meaningful performance appraisal process that supports employee performance, development and organisational objectives across the Group and its subsidiaries.

3. **Rationale and Purpose**

This Policy forms part of the Group's performance management system. It is intended to:

a) Promote talent management and succession planning.
b) Support a performance-oriented working environment.
c) Help employees understand and achieve agreed objectives.
d) Recognise employees' contributions to the progress of the organisation.
e) Explain the Group's appraisal framework and the process through which employees participate.
f) Ensure that employee performance is assessed against established standards and reviewed regularly.
g) Promote confidence and trust in the fairness of the appraisal system.
h) Help employees understand future prospects and discuss career aspirations and development needs.
i) Support job satisfaction and identify and develop successors for critical and high-responsibility positions.

4. **Scope**

   This Policy applies to all employees of Mustard Group Limited and its subsidiaries, including permanent and contract-based employees. Appraisal arrangements should take account of the employee's role, agreed responsibilities and applicable employment terms.

5. **Guiding Principles**

a) Every employee should understand the performance expectations and responsibilities attached to their role.

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b) Managers should provide the resources reasonably required to enable employees to perform and improve.
c) Employees may request feedback on their performance.
d) Appraisals must be thoughtful, evidence-based and meaningful, rather than a routine tick-box exercise.
e) Assessments should be fair, consistent and based on role-related criteria.
f) Managers should identify talent and encourage employees' professional growth.
g) The process should support healthy communication, teamwork and employee well-being.

6. Responsibilities

6.1 Employees / Appraisees

a) Complete and submit self-assessment forms, comparing achievements and work progress against agreed objectives.
b) Attend appraisal and performance-development meetings scheduled during the year.
c) Participate in and work towards the Personal Development Plan (PDP) agreed following the appraisal.
d) Provide appropriate evidence of work completed, achievements and learning undertaken during the year.
e) Complete training programmes or courses identified in the previous year's PDP, or as agreed soon after joining the organisation.
f) Submit required appraisal forms and supporting evidence by the communicated deadlines.

6.2 Immediate Supervisors / Appraisers

a) Hold regular discussions with team members on performance, progress and development.
b) Provide ongoing feedback on achievements, performance gaps and progress throughout the year.
c) Assess performance fairly against agreed objectives, role requirements and relevant evidence.
d) Maintain supporting evidence for the grades awarded and verify task-completion claims where applicable.
e) Identify potential successors for critical roles and support implementation of employees' PDPs.
f) Promote employee health and well-being, effective communication and a supportive working environment.

6.3 Heads of Institutions / Subsidiary Heads

a) Coordinate appraisal activities within their respective institutions or subsidiaries.
b) Communicate appraisal timelines and deadlines for self-appraisal and team-evaluation forms.
c) Ensure that appraisals are completed consistently and submitted to HR as required.

6.4 Human Resources Department and Management

a) Maintain an appropriate appraisal framework and templates that explain the process to employees and appraisers.
b) Coordinate and oversee the annual appraisal process, working with the relevant institutional or subsidiary heads.
c) Support consistency and fairness in the application of the Policy.
d) Review appraisal outcomes and coordinate applicable incentives after targets have been achieved and the annual appraisal completed, subject to management approval and applicable criteria.

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e) Receive employee requests for clarification or concerns about the appraisal process.

7. Appraisal Criteria

Appraisal should consider the employee's agreed objectives and overall contribution to the organisation. Relevant criteria include:

a) Achievement of agreed objectives and results of assigned tasks.
b) Job-specific skills and essential skills compliance.
c) Behaviour and demonstration of organisational values.
d) Teamwork and contribution to colleagues and the wider organisation.
e) Additional competencies and social skills.
f) Special achievements and organisational citizenship behavior.
g) Learning, development and progress against the employee's PDP.

8. Appraisal Frequency and Schedule

Routine performance appraisals will be conducted approximately every three months, with a major appraisal at the end of the year. Additional appraisals may be conducted where the need arises. The designated appraisal months are April, July/August, and November/December. Heads of Institutions or the relevant subsidiary heads will communicate the specific dates and deadlines for submission of self-appraisal forms and team-evaluation forms.

9. Appraisal Procedure

a) Communication of expectations: The appraiser explains the employee's role responsibilities, objectives, performance standards and relevant measures. Necessary resources should be identified.
b) Self-assessment: The employee completes the self-appraisal form and provides evidence of achievements, work progress and learning against agreed objectives.
c) Manager assessment: The appraiser reviews the self-assessment, verifies relevant evidence and assesses performance, behaviour and essential skills compliance.
d) Appraisal discussion: The employee and appraiser discuss achievements, performance gaps, feedback, support required and career or development aspirations.
e) Rating and documentation: The appraiser records the assessment and retains evidence supporting the grades awarded.
f) Personal Development Plan: Development needs are documented in a PDP, including relevant training or courses and agreed follow-up actions.
g) Communication and submission: Completed forms are submitted by the communicated deadline. Employees are informed of their overall performance assessment score.
h) Follow-up: The appraiser monitors progress against the PDP and agreed performance actions during the year.

10. Performance Scoring and Rating

The overall performance assessment score combines the employee's performance score against set objectives, behavioural score and essential skills compliance. Performance is assessed against the ideal points established for the employee and the extent to which the agreed objectives have been achieved.

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Rating	Description	Score range
1.	Unacceptable	0-25%
2.	Needs improvement	26- 50%
3.	Satisfactory	51-75%
4.	Good	76-100%

The rating scale above is reproduced from the existing framework. The appraisal forms should state how component scores are weighted and how boundary scores are treated, where this has been determined by the Group.

11. Outcomes and Further Action

a) Salary increments are considered annually, taking into account the institution's financial position and the employee's overall performance assessment score.
b) Employees attaining the stated 75% cut-off may be eligible for a salary increment, subject to the institution's financial position and applicable approval.
c) Employees scoring below 50% against the set ideal score will be considered for skills-improvement training and may receive a warning or memorandum relating to poor performance.
d) Three consecutive ratings below 50% are identified in the existing framework as grounds for summary dismissal. Any employment decision arising from performance concerns must be handled through the applicable disciplinary and performance-management procedures and in accordance with applicable law.
e) Employees achieving an exceptional rating of 90% and above may be considered for performance incentives, including promotion, subject to suitability, available opportunities and management approval.
f) Incentives, bonuses and other actions are determined by management based on the overall score, achievement of targets and applicable organisational conditions.

12. Evidence, Records and Transparency

a) Employees are required to provide evidence of their performance and task completion. Reporting managers or supervisors may verify such evidence.
b) Appraisers must award fair grades and retain evidence supporting the assessment.
c) Self-appraisal and team-evaluation forms must be submitted on or before the stated deadline.
d) Employees will be informed of their overall performance assessment score to support transparency.
e) Specific grades and evaluations recorded by managers will remain confidential under the existing framework.
f) An employee who is dissatisfied with an assessment or requires clarification may approach the Human Resources Department

13. Personal Development and Succession Planning

Appraisal outcomes should be used to identify learning needs, strengthen job skills, support career aspirations and improve performance. PDPs should identify relevant development actions, including training or courses, and should be followed up by the employee and appraiser. Appraisal information may also support the identification and development of successors for critical and high-responsibility positions.

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14. Policy Administration and Review

The Human Resources Department is responsible for maintaining this Policy and supporting its consistent implementation across Mustard Group Limited and its subsidiaries. The Policy should be reviewed annually or earlier where operational needs or changes in applicable requirements make a review necessary.

15. Approval

This Policy takes effect upon approval by the designated authority of Mustard Group Limited.

Approval	
Signature	
Date	

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